VIM CHEAT SHEET

For VSCode-Vim

Esc — normal mode

solid — Standard vim command (mapped to modified UK keyboard layout)

dashed — Custom remapping

motion — moves cursor or define operator range

operator — core operator; requires a range

command — immediate action. red are left in insert mode.

misc — numerics & menu-opts

~ toggle case ` repeat last command	! external filter 1	" ★ activate registry ★ 2	£ prev. occurence 3	$ toggle code folding 4	% hop group 5	^ Unfold all 6	& repeat last ':s' 7	* next occurence 8	(next sentence 9	) prev. sentence 0 start of line (hard)	_ Fold all - start of prev. line	+ start of next line = auto format
Q show tooltip q★ record macro ★	W next WORD w next word	E end of WORD e end of word	R 'replace' (insert) mode) r★ replace with ★	T★ move back 'til ★ t★ move 'til ★	Y yank line (yy) y yank (copy)	U redo u undo	I insert at linestart (soft) i insert (before) here	O open line above o open line below	P paste before p paste after	{ prev. paragraph [★ prev. ★-context	} next paragaph]★ next ★-context	
A append at line end a append (after) here	S clear line s delete character	D delete to line end (dL) d delete (and cut)	F★ find prev. ★ f★ find (move to) ★	★G move to line ★ (eof if none). g multikey prefix	H start of line (soft) h ←	J bottom of screen j ↓	K top of screen k ↑	L end of line (soft) l →	: enter cmd mode ; repeat last f, F, t or T	@★ activate macro ★ , reverse last f, F, t or T	| start of line (hard) \ end of line (hard)	
~ toggle case # prev. occurence	Z save & quit (×2) z multikey prefix	X backspace x delete	C Change to line end (cL) c change	V visual-line mode v visual mode	B prev. WORD b prev. word	N prev. search result n next search result	M mid-screen m★ mark location as ★	< de-indent ,★ jump to mark ★ (linestart)	> indent .★ jump to mark ★ (exact)	? search (back) / search (forward)		

Words & WORDS

word	a block of alphanumeric characters and underscores
WORD	a block of **any** non whitespace characters
sentence	any block of symbols ending in '.', '!' or '?', followed by whitespace.
paragraph	any text between blank lines

Search & Substitute

/[regexp]	search forward
?[regexp]	search backward
n/N	Cycle through search results
:s/old/new	Replace first old on line with new
:s/old/new/g	Replace all instances on line
:%s/old/new/g	Replace all instances in file

gg first line · { para start · K scroll top · <C-u> 1/2 up · k up line

| start line	H first char.	(sentence start	b prev. word start	h prev. char	l next char	e next word end	w next word start	) sentence end	L end line

j down line · <C-d> 1/2 down · J screen bottom · } para end · G last line

Operators & Ranges

Operators perform an action on **range**, which is defined by an (optional) count and a motion.

cmd = [operator] [count (1)] [motion]

The operator action is performed on all characters between the current cursor location and the location defined by (count)×(motion).

The Operators

y (yank)	Copy region to registry
d (delete)	Copy region to registry and delete the region
c (change)	Copy region to registry, delete the region, and enter insert mode
</> (indent)	Decrease/Increase the indent level of the region
gu/gU	Change region to lower/upper case text

If no count is specified, the motion is performed once. Counts may preceed the operator; 5yy and y5y are equivalent.

Repeating the operator command applies it to the entire current line (dd deletes the entire line)

Operator Grammar

Operator-motions work like navigation:: yW yanks everything until the end of the current WORD, and ctj changes all text up to (but not including) the first 'j'. There are also two special 'adverbs' which can be used after operators: a and i. Some keys keep their meaning (iw is 'inside the current word'), but others change drastically:

a★	'Around': All text specified by ★including the delimiters: daw deletes the current word, and the surrounding whitespace.	s	Current Sentence
		p	Current Paragraph
		(,)	Parenthesis group
		{, }	Brace group
i★	'Inside': As with a, but only the contents; diw would delete only the word.	[,]	Bracket group
		<,>	Chevron group
		t	Tag group
s★	Activates surround extension.	",'	Quoted string

Command Mode

Typing ':' enters command mode. <Enter> executes the command.

Files & Focus

:w [name]	Save [as name]
:q[!]	Close [without saving]
:sp / :vsp	Split window [vertically]
:b [file]	Focus on file [1]
:bn / :bp	Focus on next/previous file in group
:bd [file]	Close file [1]
:e [file]	Open [file]. Creates new file if no path provided
:only	Close all open groups except current
:term	Focus to terminal

Ranges & Navigation

Can apply normal mode operators to these ranges; :42d deletes line 42, without needing to navigate there.

:%	Whole file
:[a]	Select/Jump to line a (equivalent to [a]G)
:[a],[b]	Range from line a to b
:'<,'>	Current visual mode selection

Utilities

:s	Search & Substitute (see bottom left)
:noh	Clears search highlights
:ret	Replaces spaces with tabs
:sort [u]	Sort selection [and remove duplicates]
:reg	Show contents of registers

[1] Does nothing if target not in current group

Multi-character Commands

The 'z' key

za	Toggle fold
zM/zR	Fold all / Unfold all
zt/zz/zb	Scroll until cursor is at top / middle / bottom of screen

The 'g' key

gg	Motion: First line
gd	Go to definition
gu/gU	Operator: make range upper/lower case
gf	Open file under cursor

Ctrl-pairs

C-a/C-x	Incremenet/decrement numerical value under cursor
C-o/C-i	Go to previous/next position in jump history

Registers

d, y and p transfer text into a **register**. If none is specified, "" is used, otherwise commands can use a specific register; "ayy yanks to the a register, and "ap would then paste it.

Some registers are assigned automatically:

"/	Last search
"0	Last yank
"1-"9	Delete carousel ("1 is most recent delete, "2 second most recent, etc.)
"+	System clipboard (mapped to "" by default)

Macros occupy the same registry space as dyp. Marks occupy a different registry space, with a-z local to the file, A-Z shared globally.